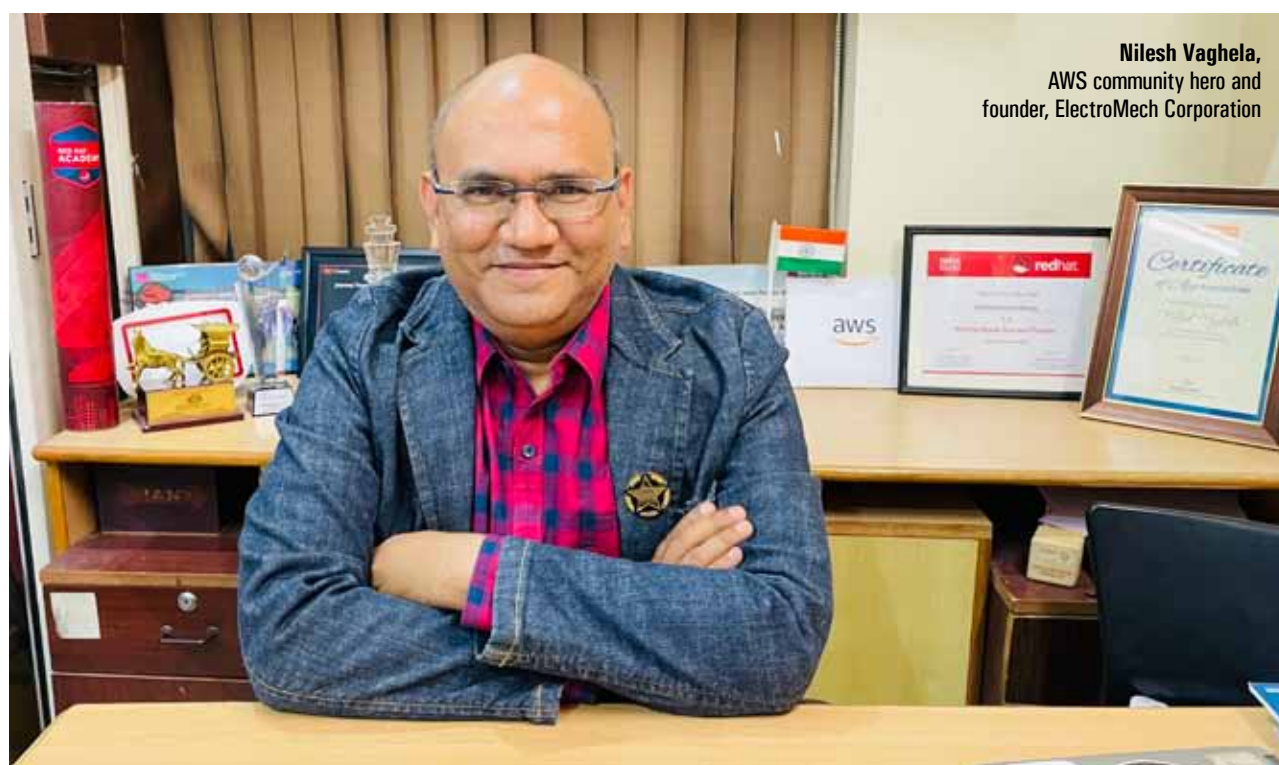


# “It’s time to contribute to open source”

**Nilesh Vaghela** is an *AWS community hero* and *founder, ElectroMech Corporation*, a cloud and open source company. According to him, contributing to open source is a rewarding act in itself. However, it needs commitment and there are many steps involved in the process, right from selecting a project to ensuring your contribution is noticed. In a conversation with **Abbinaya Kuzhanthaivel** of *OSFY*, he shares a few tips on how developers can help to improve India’s contributions to open source.



**Nilesh Vaghela,**  
AWS community hero and  
founder, ElectroMech Corporation

**Q.** Can you tell us a bit about your current role and contributions to open source.

**A.** I am currently an architect working on automation. I lead multiple teams and also contribute majorly to Invinsense, an open source security service platform. I started open source groups in early 1998 and had around 1500 members even then. A group (<https://groups.google.com/g/vglug>) I am handling now has been very active since 2014-15.

**Q.** How did you start working with open source projects?

**A.** I am a mechanical engineer by qualification, and was dealing with modems and UPS systems at my firm ElectroMech Corporation. I slowly got dragged into handling PCs, networking and Linux. I started experimenting in 1996 after getting inspired by seeing over 150 computer servers running on Linux at a Nuclear Science Centre. That’s when I converted my company entirely, focusing on open source for

training and support.

I can proudly say that I was one of the first and early adopters of open source — helping customers to understand what is open source, what are its benefits, what’s available for free, security or code issues, and so on. We got at least four or five customers in Vadodara supporting us, and we eventually promoted ourselves through advertisements in the Yellow Pages. We partnered with Red Hat and the journey continues till now.